STATION 5 HELPER GM — THE COLLAPSING ARMORY (TABOO WORD)

Pair: Frankenstein / Frank (Barbarian) & Wayne Werewolf (Barbarian) · **Goal:** stop the ceiling, decode the door password, retrieve the crest from the grate, without saying the forbidden word → **Crest #5 + Evidence Card E5**. **Target:** 10–15 min. Full rules: `Stations/Station_5_Collapsing_Armory_Corridor_of_the_Taboo_Word.md`.

Before the players arrive

- Corridor mat (Sheets A + B taped together). Rack tags in their slots: **A-top-1 Spear · A-bottom-1 Mace · A-top-2 Net · A-bottom-2 Axe · B-top-1 Glaive · B-bottom-1 Rapier · B-top-2 Halberd · B-bottom-2 Executioner's Blade**.
- Five ceiling word cards face up, scrambled. Tracker slider at **15 FT**. Archway plaque ready to hand over. Blueprint (give it when they examine the grate).
- Bell (or squeaky toy), 1-minute sand timer by the door, penalty cards 1–8 face down, a d8, the pups token. Phone stopwatch.

Your special job: the word, the bell and the ceiling

- **The forbidden word is TRAP. You never say it**, not even in rules talk. Call it "the word" and point at the plaque.
- **Counts:** trap, traps, trapped, trapdoor, booby-trap, mousetrap, "it's a trap!", spelling it aloud, reading it off a sheet. **Doesn't count:** strap, trapeze, other languages (piège, Falle, trampa), writing, miming, pointing.
- **Each slip:** ring the bell → roll d8 and show that penalty card → flip the sand timer (the door is **locked 1 minute**, and passwords during a lockout are ignored). The ceiling keeps moving.
- **Watch Frank's sheet:** the *Massive Shoulders* text contains the word. If Frank's player reads it aloud word for word, ring the bell with a big grin.
- **The ceiling:** every real minute, slide the tracker down **1 ft** and say it aloud (*"Thirteen feet. Grrrind."*). **CROUCH at 5 ft** (half speed). **CRUSH at 0 ft** (minute 15): the floor tilts and dumps everyone out the door (2d6 each, nobody drops below 1 HP). It **stops** the moment Frank braces.

Station clock

Time	Do this
0:00	Hand over the plaque, explain the rule once (Player Introduction), start the stopwatch.
2:30	**Envelope 1** if they haven't connected the ceiling words to the racks.
5:00–6:00	**Envelope 2** when Frank goes toward the ceiling (DC 11 Perception or Investigation, or automatic if he touches it).
8:00–9:00	**Envelope 3** once they've matched 3 or more cards, or when they inspect the door.
11:00	Stuck: **Envelope 4**, the variant that fits.
15:00	Lead GM's bell = hard stop. Then **Envelope 5** and send them to the Gate.

STATION 5 HELPER GM — RUNNING THE ROOM

Answer key (DM eyes only)

- **Ceiling:** Frank stands under the gargoyle boss and uses **Massive Shoulders** (Action, automatic success). While braced he can't move, but his player can still talk and sort cards.
- **Password:** match the 5 ceiling words to rack tags (by eye, or Investigation DC 12 per card). Lit racks: **S**pear, **N**et, **A**xe, **R**apier, **E**xecutioner's Blade. First letters from entrance to door = **SNARE**. The plaque already lists "snares" as an allowed word. Wrong passwords just make the stone mouth cough dust.
- **Decoy:** the Sylvan Halberd tag looks like the Elvish Rapier card. Elvish loops are **closed**; Sylvan loops are **open**.
- **The crest is in the RIGHT pipe.** Wayne's Wolf Senses: Perception DC 10 with advantage hears it. Swarm of Pups fetches it, and **one use lasts the whole station**. Sent without listening, roll 1d3: 1 left (broken sword hilt), 2 centre (soggy boot), 3 right (crest!). Each wrong pipe costs about a minute.
- **Exit:** Frank lets go and dives for the door: DC 10 Dex or 1d6 piercing. He always makes it.

d8 penalty table (scaled)

d8	Effect
1	Wall Arrows: +5 to hit, 1d6+2 piercing
2	Constricting Vines: DC 13 Str or Restrained (Action + DC 13 Athletics to break free; Frank has advantage)
3	Heat Metal: drop the item or take 1d8 fire
4	Blinding Flash: DC 13 Cha or blinded 1 round
5	Flame Jet: DC 13 Dex, 2d6 fire, half on a save (Frank yelps; he's scared of fire)
6	Grease Siphon: DC 13 Dex or prone
7	Pendulum Blade: +5 to hit, 1d8+3 slashing
8	Ceiling Surge: the ceiling drops 2 ft at once (if Frank is braced: DC 13 Athletics with advantage, or the drop happens anyway and he takes 1d6)

Nudges (questions only)

- *"The words on the ceiling are glowing. How many racks are there? How many words?"*
- *"Do any of those squiggles look like anything else in the room?"*
- *"Who in the party has the loudest muscles for that ceiling?"* (point at Frank, not at the ability)
- *"You've got five weapons. What's the door waiting for?"* / *"Read your plaque again. What are you allowed to talk about?"*
- At the grate: *"Your hands won't fit. Who's small enough?"* / *"Wayne, which way do your nose and ears point?"*

Derails

- **Saying it on purpose for laughs:** it still counts. On a third deliberate slip within a minute, it's automatically **result 8**: "the room gets bored of the joke."
- **Arguing over variants:** one sentence from the table above, then move on.
- **Clever workarounds** (other languages, miming, a hand over a mouth): allowed. Praise them!
- **Prying the grate or door:** fused to the bedrock. Give them a fair roll, but it doesn't budge.

Don't

- Never say the word, "SNARE", "first letters" or "in order" before Envelope 3. Never point at a rack.
- Never name *Massive Shoulders* or *Swarm of Pups*; point at the sheets instead. Nobody goes to 0 HP here.

STATION 5 — ENVELOPE LABELS

ENVELOPE 1 · LOOK AROUND

Station 5 · Armory. Open at **2:30** if they haven't linked the words to the racks.

ENVELOPE 2 · YOUR SHEET

Station 5 · Armory. Open when Frank goes toward the ceiling (**5–6 min**).

ENVELOPE 3 · THE RULE

Station 5 · Armory. Open after 3+ matches, or a door inspection (**8–9 min**).

ENVELOPE 4 · SEALED: EMERGENCY

Station 5 · Armory. **Helper only.** At 11:00 if stuck, or after a critical mistake.

ENVELOPE 5 · REWARD

Station 5 · Armory. Open on solve: **Crest #5 + Evidence Card E5**.

ENVELOPE CONTENTS

ENVELOPE 1 · THE PULSING WORDS (READ ALOUD)

> The ceiling grinds down another notch. The five glowing words on its underside pulse all at once, and each time they flash, a soft brass "ping" answers from somewhere along the weapon racks. Not all of the racks. Some of them.

ENVELOPE 2 · THE KEYSTONE BOSS (READ ALOUD)

> Frank notices the spiked ceiling isn't one solid slab. All eight piston shafts meet at a single stone gargoyle boss right above the floor grate. Something big enough could hold that one point and stop the whole thing. Frank's shoulders twitch.

ENVELOPE 3 · THE DOOR'S MOUTH (READ ALOUD)

> Five empty sockets above the blast door light up, and the carved stone mouth whispers: "From the first steel to the last, take the head of every lit blade, and speak it plain."

ENVELOPE 4 · BILGE SURGE (READ ALOUD)

A · stuck on the password:

> The ceiling's weight cracks the five glowing words loose. They drop with a clang, each one landing on its own rack. The lit racks are now obvious.

B · stuck on the crest:

> A surge of drain water floods the sump! Wayne hears the brass chain sliding down the RIGHT pipe toward a bottomless drop. If anything small is going down there, it has to be NOW!

ENVELOPE 5 · EVIDENCE CARD E5: THE STINKY GLOVE

Goes in with Crest #5.

> The pups drag up a glove along with the crest. It reeks of rotten eggs: **sulfur**.